

Interviewer: So, can I ask you what your partner's first name is, please?

Participant: (partner).

Interviewer: (Partner). And what would you like us to call her during this interview? So, it could be by her first name, we could call her wife, partner, spouse.

Participant: (partner), that's great.

Interviewer: Great. And how long have you been with (partner)?

Participant: For nearly [16-20] years.

Interviewer: [16-20], okay. I'd like you to tell me a little bit about your love story and the relationship you're currently in. How did it start? How did it develop?

Participant: So, it developed through a meeting, without necessarily being an meeting, at college. When I say an meeting without being a meeting, it's... In secondary school, well, we're young, I was maybe [11-15] at the time, when I saw her for the first time, and I thought she was a pretty girl. So that's... In fact, I say that as the beginning of a relationship, because for me, it's a bit like the beginning of a relationship, even though I didn't get into a relationship with her when I was [11-15]. But not long after that first visual encounter, I'd say, we chatted at a little end-of-year high school party, at a friend of hers' house, where I was also invited. Back then, we were just starting to use cell phones and text messaging. So we sent each other a lot of text messages. After that, we went our separate ways for different reasons, studies and so on. We met up again when I was [16-20] and she was [16-20]. And that's when we finally got together and have been together ever since.

Interviewer: Right. And what was the context of this reunion when you were [16-20]?

Participant : In fact, we've never really lost sight of each other, because we've always been looking for each other. But I think in any case, I, for one, and this is a bit crazy because it's true, and when I think about it, I think it's crazy to have said that when I was [16-20]. But I remember when I was [16-20], talking to my friends about girls and so on. And in fact, my friends at the time knew that I really liked (partner) and they teased me a lot about it. And I always told them that I wouldn't get involved with her right away, because I knew that once I was with her, it would be for the rest of my life. And in fact, I think she kind of knows that too. So we went our separate ways for school. We didn't go to the same high school. Afterwards, she moved to another town to go to university. And in fact, we found each other without finding each other, because in fact, we always exchanged regularly. Back then, there was [Messaging]. So we always exchanged via messaging rather than face-to-face. Eventually, as a result of these exchanges, we met up again and got together.

Interviewer: How do you explain that feeling you had of "I know that if we're together, it'll be forever"?

Participant: Because I think it was... Because in fact, I already knew her a little bit because we'd exchanged a lot. So I could see that she was a bit different from the other girls I'd been around or whatever. And that she was a girl, not that the others weren't serious, but in any case, I saw her as ultra-serious. And I knew that's what I needed. So that's why, I think, I said that to myself at the time.

Interviewer: Right. And so when you got together, was it something that clicked, or was it something that happened gradually?

Participant : It didn't happen gradually. In fact, it's a bit special. So we were looking for each other a lot. And of course, when you're [16-20], you go to a lot of parties. At least, that's the case. And at one party, I was working a bit on the weekends in addition to my studies. I was going out to a fast-food restaurant and one evening, she told me to come to a party where she was. So I went. In fact, she's... I'm going to say something horrible. But that's fine (laughs). She had consumed a lot of alcohol and was very insistent. So I pushed her off a lot. And in fact, the next day, she more or less remembered what had happened. I told her she'd been a bit too insistent and that I'd pushed her off. And in fact, that evening, we met again at another party. That's when we got together.

Interviewer: Right. How has your relationship developed since then?

Participant: Then we... Back then, we lived with our parents. We saw each other a lot. Either she'd come to my parents', or I'd go to her parents'. It was very regular, in fact. We were together a lot. And then, [1-5] years after we became a couple, we moved into an apartment. We moved into an apartment, and after that, we made our way together through the various changes on the professional side, where we really supported one another. And then, above all, there was a turning point in our relationship: at a certain point, we said to ourselves that we were going to change our lives in the sense that we were going to move completely, because we'd been living in the same place for [26-30] years, her or me. It's a small region. I mean, we're from a region, a small... medium-sized town, but we all know each other, and so on. And even professionally, it was a bit blocking. So we decided to move. So we... Not on a whim, but almost. We packed our things and moved 700 km to a big city. And then, [1-5] years later, we got married. [6-10] months after the wedding, [6-10] months after the wedding, we had a child. And that was it. It all came together.

Interviewer: Right. So it all came together. You told me you've been together for [16-20] years?

Participant: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay. How long ago did you get married?

Participant: That was in [Year]. So it's going to be [1-5] years this year.

Interviewer: Okay. Great. And you were telling me about when you moved in together. Did moving in together change anything in the relationship, or was it something that happened quite naturally?

Participant: No, it happened quite naturally because we saw each other all the time. We were... Either I stayed at her place and slept at her place, her parents' place. Or she'd come to stay with me, i.e. my parents, and she'd sleep at my place. So in fact, we already had this "routine" of living together all the time. There were our parents, but we already saw each other every day. So it wasn't a big change, except that in the evenings, it was just the two of us. So we had to take more responsibility for ourselves, because it was no longer Mum or Dad who cooked the meals, but it was up to us to take care of that. But that was the real change. And then, despite everything, there's another change, which is that we're starting to share a financial routine too, I'd say, because when you take an apartment, there are expenses. So we're also learning how to share expenses and how things work. You also get to see each other's desires in terms of what you want to buy for dinner, what you want to buy in terms of furniture, and how you see things. In fact, we see other things in spite of everything in this change. And I think that also determines whether the person is really right for us. Because living together, even if it was regular, but it was at our parents', you don't do everything, you don't express everything. The fact that it's just the two of us makes a big difference.

Interviewer: Yes, it's a complete routine that's shared in the end.

Participant: Totally, yes. Totally.

Interviewer: you told me about another big change, so this 700 km move, you said, I think?

Participant: Yeah, 700, yeah.

Interviewer: And how has this changed your relationship as a couple, if at all?

Participant : Actually, I don't know if it changed it, but it was a bit of a special time. We'd been together for [6-10] years. I think I needed a change too, clearly. When I say change, I don't mean leaving her and having someone else, that's not it. But I did need a change in my life, whether it was personal or professional. And in fact, there were subjects that were a bit irritating in relation to our families, with pseudo-obligations to say, this evening we're going to eat at my parents', that day we're going to eat at my parents'. And in fact, I know that this subject annoyed me a little, as it did her. And then, beyond that, beyond the personal side, on the professional side, we also saw that we were more or less limited on the field of possibilities where we were, because we weren't in a big city and despite everything, it's still pretty closed. So, I'm certainly more of a careerist than she is, even if I don't really like the term, but that's the reality of the situation. And in fact, there was her little sister who lived in the town where we moved, who had gone there to study. We'd been going there regularly, she'd been there for [1-5] years, we went there twice a year, and we discovered the town. So we were in the [City A], in the [region], not far from [City B]. And then her little sister was in [City C]. And in fact, we went there often, well often, two or three times a year.

And in fact, we liked this big city which, in the end, is a big city, but it's not a big city, I think, like any other. It's not [City D], it's not [City B], I think it's much more family-oriented. And then, the spirit is not the same in the city, the security too. In fact, we really liked this city. We also thought that professionally, it could offer us other things too. In fact, a childhood friend of mine, who was my age, died of cancer. I was [26-30] at the time. He had two children. And at some point, I told her that, in fact, a lot can happen in life. And I don't really want to have any regrets. Because, in fact, anything can happen. And I tell myself that if you have a desire, you have to go for it. And in fact, it was the summer of [2016-2020], and we were both on vacation in [Country A]. She saw that there was a possibility of transferring to [City B]. And in fact, right there, she made the necessary arrangements. And in the end, [1-5] months later, we told her that in [1-5] weeks, she had to be in [City B]. And that was that. In [1-5] weeks, we had to leave our apartment, organize a move and find an apartment here. So it was a bit complicated. But in the end, it worked out. Because I think that with a lot of willpower, you can achieve a lot of things. So it was a real change. Very complicated at first. Because, in fact, we have [26-30] years of routine. And two, you lose. And now we're losing everything. We arrive, then there's her little sister, but in fact, that's all there is. Our family's gone, even though our family's been with us forever. So the beginnings were complicated. But in the end, I know that on a personal level, I feel incapable of leaving here. Or at least go back to where we were. And it's a bit the same for her. Because now we've made a life here. We've made new friends. Because that's what's so complicated in the beginning. Beyond family, it's the friends we've always had. And in the end, you don't see them in the same way anymore. Because we used to see them every week, every [1-5] weeks. And in fact, that's no longer the case. But then, as you grow up, you make new acquaintances. I think you also become aware of what a real friend is. And in fact, when you have friends, whether you're 10 km away or 700 km away, it makes no difference. It's just that the people are there. So, inevitably, it makes a difference. But it's not necessarily a bad thing that it sorts out the friends. Afterwards, you build up a new circle of acquaintances and potential friends. And afterwards, life is fun too. It changes. I liked the change. I really liked it.

Interviewer: You've been able to recreate a bit of a social life in [City B].

Participant: Yes. So it's not easy. Because when you're [26-30] and you don't have children. Because really, children help a lot. It doesn't seem like it, but in fact, it helps a lot. So it's not exactly easy. What's more, in [City B], there are a lot of people in the same situation as us, who arrive from out of town and don't know anyone. So it was a bit complicated at first. Luckily, her little sister was there. So we still had someone we knew and saw regularly. But at first, it was complicated. In the beginning, it was complicated. You can also make new acquaintances through your work. For me, given the job I had, it didn't fit. I couldn't afford to make work-related friends. So, it was more her, in fact, who was the catalyst on that subject, through her work colleagues. At the end of the day, we talk, see each other, meet up again and so on. And then we get to know other people. After that, I think our social life here really started when our daughter went to nursery school.

Interviewer: Okay.

Participant: Because clearly, we meet a lot of people. Because we see other parents, we have the same problems. So we talk about it, meet up one evening and see each other again. And then, the kids like to see each other. We see each other for the kids, and that creates affinities. Our daughter hasn't been at the crèche for almost [1-5] year now. And we regularly see parents of children with whom she was at nursery. Because, in fact, we've forged bonds, created affinities, seen each other's affinities. And in the end, we see each other regularly.

Interviewer: I see. I'll move on a bit. But if you had to compare the quality of your current relationship with the relationships you see your friends having, what would you say?

Participant: Our relationship versus that of our friends?

Interviewer: Yes, that's right. I

Participant: It's strange because... Personally, I don't talk too much about my life. People don't really know what's going on in my life and in my relationship. But the fact that I don't talk about my life means they don't talk about theirs either. There aren't really many moments when we can talk to each other about these subjects. At least, I don't feel the need to. So that's not the case. Now, from what I can see, it's all façade. I'd say there are three categories. There are those where you can see, and it's really obvious, that the couple is really consolidated and that they really work as a team. I say this especially in relation to the children. In our circle of friends, there are mostly parents. And you quickly see those who work as a team and are really solid. It's a real partnership. That's the first category. Then there are those where I think there's a lot of pretence when you see them. And that in their life together, it's not crazy. And then there are those where you can tell things aren't going well. But at the same time, in our circle of friends, we see a lot of people who split up after having children. Because it's not easy. Especially when you don't have a family around. It's mostly these people, I think, who break up. But they don't have the family around, because we're dealing with the kids 24/7. As a result, we no longer have a life as a couple. And when you no longer have a life as a couple, what happens is this. At some point, I think one of us gets tempted and goes off to do something else. And that brings negativity. And mechanically, if this gets out, it could potentially lead to a separation. And if it's not known, it's felt. And it can also potentially lead to a separation. So it's very much a question of how I see other couples. I don't necessarily compare myself to them, because we all experience things in different ways. We don't necessarily absorb things in the same way. Some people can't stand it, I'm talking nonsense, they need to go out three times a week with friends because it's their equilibrium. And there are others who don't need that. I'm one of them, many of them, who don't necessarily need that. So, in fact, we're all different. We don't all take things in the same way. It's difficult, I find, not to make a comparison, but almost a comparison between what we experience and what others experience.

Interviewer: You also told me that there are certain couples where you can see that things aren't going well between the two partners. How can you tell when a couple isn't doing well?

Participant: It's tension. It's ways of talking. It's looks. In fact, you can tell very quickly

from a look whether a person is annoyed or not. In any case, I think you can tell pretty quickly. And you can also tell if... It's through little signs of attention. It's by... I'm talking nonsense. We're together. There are three or four couples together. Let's say we're having a tea party. There are children. Because our circle of friends is made up of parents with children. In fact, we'll soon see... Because the subject of children is always a subject. And we'll quickly see at some point, I don't know, if there's a child who's doing something. If one of the parents reacts. All you have to do is look at the other parent's face to see if it's right for him or her. And you can quickly see if there's a problem. Clearly, I find it very visible. But then, I do a lot of... I've... I've always been a stickler for observation. I don't know why, but I like it. And in fact, I see it quickly. If it's right or wrong. You don't even have to talk about it to see if it's right or not. It's the looks, the gestures, the attitudes, the way you talk. The answers we talk about. The exchanges. I think it's easy to see things.

Interviewer: Okay. And this time, if you had to compare your current relationship with previous relationships. I don't know if you've had any. But what would you say?

Participant: It's complicated because we've been together for... Me, since I was a kid, we've been together for [16-20] years. So, I'm almost 50-50, 50% of my life with her. 50% of my life without her. And in fact, before, I never had any... It was all little crushes. There's never been anything serious. So it's impossible to compare, really. It's impossible. I haven't actually known anyone... Before I was with her, I never stayed with anyone for more than a month. So there you go. All right, then. I can't compare. It wouldn't be... It's not comparable.

Interviewer: I understand. I'd like you to tell me what a high-quality relationship is for you.

Participant: A high-quality relationship. I think it... I'm going to use terms there. I'd say loyalty, fidelity. Listening, sharing, communicating. Trust. I think that's what it comes down to. And pulling each other up. I think if you have all that, I'm pretty sure you're in a high-quality relationship. Clearly.

Interviewer: How do you know when you're in a relationship where there's loyalty and fidelity, for example?

Participant: It's trust. Clearly, it's trust. After that, it's also a feeling. I think you can feel it. Because at some point, I think we all have habits. And when our habits change, there's bound to be a trigger. It may not be infidelity at all, but it can be.

Interviewer: When would you say your relationship was the most... a relationship of loyalty, fidelity, if there was a particular moment when you really felt that?

Participant: During the first few years. Definitely. I'd say over the first [1-5]-[6-10] years.

Interviewer: And why?

Participant: Because it's the beginning. And because the beginning isn't the same. Because at the beginning, there isn't the same routine. Then, in my case, we spent [1-5] years without living together. In fact, I think the distance helps a lot. Because in fact, the fact of missing each other, I think it brings something positive. And that's why I'd say that for me personally, it's really the first [1-5] - [6-10] years. Because actually, there were [1-5] years, so even though we saw each other all the time, we weren't living together either. And then after that, we were in the early stages of moving into an apartment, so that created something nice: we had friends over, we went to friends' houses. And that was the case for us, we moved in, but we had other friends who were also moving in. And then, at that point, we also stopped going out. At least, that was the case for us. We hardly went out anymore, we didn't go to parties with [16-20] people, with other people we didn't know, we didn't go to clubs or pre-parties, it was no longer something that happened. Whereas before, it was something more than regular, it was a routine. Every week, I'd go out two or three times. And then it wasn't like that anymore.

Interviewer: Okay. You told me that...

Participant: I think that...

Interviewer: Ah, go ahead.

Participant: I think that helps too, that.

Interviewer: You told me that, for you, I think, that longing and distance can be very important in a relationship too.

Participant: Yeah.

Interviewer: Could you tell me more about that?

Participant : Actually, because I transpose it to what I'm experiencing. Clearly, you're with someone 24 hours a day. We see each other in the morning, we see each other in the evening, we sleep together. And then, in fact, it's the same thing every day. And I think that breaking the routine is a positive thing, because I see it in two senses. The first is that you break the routine and the person isn't next to you. So in fact, I think it also brings out certain feelings. And it can be feelings of fear, of dread, because the person, maybe they... I mean, even if you know them, even if you trust them, maybe you're thinking that they could make a mistake, because if they go away for a weekend with some girlfriends, for example, you might think, what could happen, etc.? In fact, I think it's very positive because it creates a feeling of insecurity. And as a result, I think that when you see the person again, you pay more attention. So I think that's a positive thing. The second is on the other side. When I say "distance", I don't mean living apart. It doesn't mean moving away from each other. It means having moments when we're not actually together, but on a regular basis. But I also think that's why there's a lot of... Because I see more and more of them. I don't necessarily know about it, but I hear about it, where people are together, but not living together. Because they need their independence and so on. And in fact, I think it's really

important to be able to take time for oneself, to find oneself again, to not have the constraints of a couple. Because in fact, being a couple is for two, but it also brings constraints. If I'm on my own, it's 8.30pm, I don't have my daughter at home and I don't have my wife, the first thing I'm going to say to myself is I'm not going to make myself dinner, I'm going to order something, just for a change. And so, I'll take the car, I'll go and get something, it gets me out a bit, it also breaks my day's rhythm. I did my day, I left home, it was 8am, I came home, it was 8pm, it brings me a little something positive. And then, I don't have any constraints, so I can move around, come back in, if I feel like watching a film, I'll watch it, but at the same time, I'll watch a film that I want to see myself, without thinking, will the other person like it? Because then, if we're together, we'll consult each other. I'm not going to say, I'm going to get something to eat, I'm going to say, I feel like eating something different, what do you feel like eating? At the risk of her saying, "no, I've already prepared something, we'll eat that", or I'll get frustrated. In fact, you can get into something a bit negative. And that's why I think it's so important to have time for yourself. But time for yourself, I think, to be alone, not necessarily to say, I'm going to go out with friends, etc. It's time for yourself, alone. It's time for yourself, but I don't think it's the same thing. It's time for yourself, alone. I think that's really important. In my opinion, in fact, it's a small distance, because we're not together. It's not really a distance, it's that we're not together. And I think it's important to have these moments alone.

Interviewer: Yes, moments to break the rhythm up a bit, we're a couple, we're together all the time, to have moments where it's up to you, where you decide on your own.

Participant: Without constraint. Because when I say without constraint, it's negative, but it's more or less the reality. And there's the double constraint, there's the constraint of having someone to live with. When I say constraint, it's not really the right word, but it's the fact that in fact, you're doing things according to another person, but it's double, because you're also doing things according to a child. And above all, when you have a child, you're mostly doing things for them. So that's another barrier.

Interviewer: We were talking a bit about loyalty and fidelity. Were there times when you felt your relationship was less loyal, less faithful?

Participant: I know... On the one hand, yes, on the other hand, no. On the one hand, yes, because... I also think it's important to feel wanted. And at some point, when it's not our partner who's providing it, I think... Without necessarily wanting to... I'm not sure if it's consciously, but I think we'll look for it elsewhere. That doesn't mean we'll make mistakes, but I think we'll look for it. And from the moment we go looking for it... So it's not loyalty, but I think it's... For me, it's more the loyalty side that stands out. I'm not saying it's a lack of loyalty, but maybe there's a little less of it at that point. And I think that overall, I think this is a very regular topic in couples. I don't think it's negative, because I think it's useful as long as you manage to be solid and tell yourself that you won't do anything foolish. But it's not... I see it almost as a game, in the end, to say "Am I still desirable? Am I creating that feeling in someone else?" What if... Personally, I think that if we have a branch open to us, we can seize it, this branch, and we can be tempted to want to play,

you know. Without necessarily saying that you're going to make a mistake. I think this part is a subject.

Interviewer: I understand. And you also told me that a high-quality relationship is one where there's listening, sharing and communication. How do you know when you're in a relationship where you're communicating, listening and sharing?

Participant : In fact, for me, it's the same as what we were saying earlier. I think it's something that's very easy to see. Because someone who's listening to someone else is going to be attentive, is going to be caring, and is going to... Let me give you a simple example. Someone who's saying something to someone else, if we're listening properly, sharing properly, the other person will absorb what's being said and, once the other person has finished what he or she has to say, will perhaps say things in a subtle way to say "OK, yes, I understand what you're saying, but I don't necessarily think the same as you, I think more like this, for this, for this, for this." And in fact, there's respect in the exchange. Two people talking, but one says one thing, the other says something else, cuts himself off, one speaks louder than the other, and so on. For me, that's not good listening, it's not good sharing, it's not good communication. So it's all the same. I think you can feel it in the attitude, in the gestures, in the tone, in the intonation of the voice. It's very visible, too. It's very visible.

Interviewer :Yes, so it's also a question of respecting the other person's word, in short.

Participant: Clearly. That's just my opinion.

Interviewer: That's what we're here for.

Participant: So I think so.

Interviewer: And when would you say that your relationship was most about communication and sharing?

Participant: It's the same, in the first [1-5]-[6-10] years. I think it's clearly related.

Interviewer And were there times when you felt it was a little less communicative, a little less about sharing?

Participant : Her?

Interviewer: It, your relationship.

Participant: Ah, OK. Yes, of course. Yes, of course.

Interviewer: What kind of moments in general do you feel that way about?

Participant: I think it's about moments of annoyance. It can be created by fatigue. I always come back to this, but when you have a child, life changes a lot. The notion of fatigue, I think that's where we discover it, in the end. In any case, maybe we discover it beforehand, because some jobs are extremely tiring. I think that people who work at night, nurses, nurses who work at night, necessarily, I think that fatigue, they know it before having children. I'm not saying that people who work in offices or the like don't experience fatigue, but in any case, I think it comes as a shock the day you have a child, because when you end up sleeping 3 hours a night, and in the morning you still have to get up at 7 a.m. to go to work, and you've slept 3 hours, and in fact that's 5 nights in a row, mechanically, you don't have the same patience. It's only logical. And that's when you stop listening, because maybe you don't even want to listen anymore. So I think that's one of those moments when you just don't have the patience, when I don't think you're listening in the same way.

Interviewer: And so we talked about what a high-quality relationship is for you. That's something we've already talked about, but what would define a low-quality relationship?

Participant: It's a relationship that doesn't really hang on to much. It's a relationship where, on a whim, there can be a separation. On a whim, I say stupid things, but on a whim, I don't know, a person who's wondering about his professional life, who's going through a bit of a hard time, if the relationship isn't of good quality, very often, it fizzles out everywhere. If the relationship isn't up to scratch, very often it's a case of all hell breaking loose. On the other hand, if you have a solid couple, if you have a solid relationship, I think the couple will get over it. It's not the individual who's going to overcome it alone. It's the two of them who will overcome it together. So I think that at the slightest hard blow, whether it's personal or professional, personal-personal, personal-couple or professional, at the slightest hard blow, a separation, mechanically, the couple had major weaknesses. That's for sure.

Interviewer: So in the end, it's a great fragility in the couple, where it doesn't hold together when there's something that impacts a little bit.

Participant: That's it.

Interviewer: So, as adjectives for a high-quality relationship, you talked about loyalty, faithfulness, listening, sharing, communication, trust, pulling the other person up. Are there any other things you think are important in a loving relationship?

Participant: Um... Uh... I don't think they're coming to me right now, compared to what I've already said. I don't think so.

Interviewer: And now I'd like you to tell me, from your own experience, what love means to you.

Participant : Uh... What is love? You should know that I'm not at all someone who asks these kinds of questions, by the way, generally. What is love? Love, I'd say, is... a feeling...that... brings with it many emotions, both positive and negative. In other words, when...when the other

person experiences something good, well, we're going to feel it that way too, and it's going to create a positive emotion for us. And when the other person experiences something not so good, we're also going to be... in that part, i.e. we're going to feel the same thing. So... I think I'd define it like that.

Interviewer: So a little emotional tuning.

Participant: Yeah, sharing emotions.

Interviewer: And how important would you say love is in a relationship?

Participant: I think it's really important. Because if there isn't love, then I think the relationship is in jeopardy. There are a lot of people today, and we see it around us, well I see it, there are a lot of people who stay together on principle because they have children. Because they've bought a house. Because they have one or more children. And, well, it's very complicated to change all that. So they stay together out of compulsion, out of love. But mechanically, that only leads to negativity.

Interviewer: And we also know that there are different forms and ways of loving. So I'd like you to tell me about how you know (partner) loves you.

Participant : Uh... By her attentions. By her attentions. And by respect. Respect in speech, respect in the way things are done or said. Honestly, I'd say on those points. But above all, little acts of attention.

Interviewer: Could you give me some examples, if any come to mind, of times when you've felt this attention giving towards you?

Participant: It's silly stuff. It's really just stuff... It's almost trivial, but I'll say anything. I'm at work. She's... I don't know, it's noon, she sends me a message. "I'm here, I've come to eat with you. "We're going to have a bite to eat together." I think it's a wonderful gesture. "I'm at home, she's going to come close to me, she's going to have a tender moment. I think that's wonderful.

Interviewer: It's really the little everyday things that matter. I'd also like you to tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had with (partner).

Participant: One of the last positive interactions I've had with (partner)? It's an exchange about professional life.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Participant : Actually, it's that we're interested in each other.

Interviewer: Okay. And conversely, one of the last negative interactions you might have had with her?

Participant: On the daily routine.

Interviewer: A discussion about that, right?

Participant : Uh... Yeah, it's not even a discussion. That's... You make the other person understand that they're fed up with doing this. "I'm sick of making dinner", for example. It can be that, where the other person doesn't even say it, but makes it clear with a look, what, that I'm tired of doing this.

Interviewer: And...

Participant: Preparing meals is a whole subject.

Interviewer: And actually, I'd like you to tell me about the conflicts and arguments you may have with your partner.

Participant: Yes. Er... Um... What can we say about the conflicts and disputes that are present? Er...Well, it's... In fact, it can be a burden, because there's too much of it at times. Er... I think conflicts and arguments are very often a sign of poor communication. As soon as you don't know how to talk, you don't know how to talk to each other, it inevitably leads to arguments where you don't understand each other, you don't say things in the right way, you don't say things to each other. I'm a lot like that. Well... Actually, I know... I'm won't say that I don't know how to express myself, but I'm more going to say that I don't like doing it.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Participant: But maybe I don't like doing it, because I don't know how to do it. Er... And so, inevitably, it can lead to... It can lead to... More heated exchanges. And it's not... And it's not... In fact, it's not pleasant. Uh... It's not pleasant at all, in fact. Clearly, it's not... It's painful. It's... It's painful. These moments are painful, but at the same time, they're part of everyday life. And then, do we accept them? Do we not accept them? I think that those who do accept them, well, they... They don't make a big deal out of it.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Participant : And those who don't accept them, well, they'll take... They'll use it as a pretext, in quotation marks, to... To tell themselves they're not meant to be together.

Interviewer: Yes, so we're not necessarily trying to solve it, but instead thinking "well if we're fighting, then things are just not right and that's it".

Participant: That's it. Yeah, that's it.

Interviewer: And you told me that it can happen more or less... I mean, it can happen more or less often. What would you say is the frequency of your conflicts over [1-5] weeks, for example?

Participant: oh, they're regular, I'd say.

Interviewer: Hmm?

Participant: It's regular, isn't it. It's... I'd say it's once every 3 days, the conflicts.

Interviewer: And as an object of conflict, we talked about the organization of meals. Is there anything else that often causes conflict?

Participant: Well, it's the organization of life, generally speaking. It's daily life, it's... It's the time you don't have for yourself, it's because you have a child, so it's education.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Participant: I think that's a source of conflict too. Because, well, we don't necessarily approach things in the same way. And that can lead to conflict. Er... Yeah. I think that's a source of conflict, education.

Interviewer: And how do you come to a resolution afterwards? How do you resolve these conflicts? By what means?

Participant : It depends. That's right, because at some point, things calm down and we can talk to each other. And then we explain things to each other. And we tell each other things in a much calmer way. In fact, we realize that... Well, it's just that we don't say it in the same way. It's just that we haven't said it in the same way. Or else, time. Time.

Interviewer: And so, apart from these means you told me about, what other means do you use to maintain your relationship with (partner)?

Participant: Well... So, when you say "by what other means", what are the means...? Uh... If we recap, what are the means we mentioned?

Interviewer: Uh... What do you mean?

Participant: Because the question is "by what other means"?

Interviewer: Yes, yes. So you were telling me, for example, to resolve arguments, there's communication, there's time which helps things to get better, but in general, in your relationship, how do you maintain it? How do you make this relationship last?

Participant: Well, I think... Because even if there are moments that are complicated, given that we've known each other for years and that we've been together for [16-20] years, I think we also know... We also know that our foundations are pretty solid and that the fundamentals of this relationship are, in fact, pretty... It's pretty solid, in fact. So I think we remember it at some point and we know that it's an important subject. After that, it's only by paying attention that we can maintain all that.

Interviewer: Hmm. And now I'd like you to tell me what you think the challenges are in your relationship.

Participant: What challenges there are? So far?

Interviewer: Challenges you've already overcome, challenges you think you'll have to face together in the future?

Participant: Well, it's... I think the biggest challenge, and it's certainly linked to the fact that we've been together for a very long time and that we've known each other for a very long time, is the evolution of each other. Because over time we evolve, on subjects, adult subjects, which is less the case when we're [16-20] and [16-20]... and I think that's the biggest challenge, is that... we may not evolve in the same way. In other words, at a given moment, one of us may take charge and say, well, this way of living or doing things doesn't suit me anymore, I'm working on myself and I see things in a different way, etc. Will the other accept this? Will the other person also evolve in that direction or in a different direction, but will we be able to accept it? And in fact, in our relationship at least, I think that's really the most striking element, that we don't evolve in the same way. Now, whether we accept it or not, that's the question we have to ask ourselves.

Interviewer: You're telling me that you don't evolve in the same way. What's the difference between the two of you?

Participant : It's perceptions about... in particular the professional aspect, the business part, or the balance linked to the family. In other words, for her, in an ideal world, we'd take our daughter to school in the morning, she'd have a full day at school and someone would pick her up at 4:30. So that's her ideal world, that's what she'd like. I'm a little more pragmatic, in fact I can see that it's almost impossible to do that, because we don't have our parents nearby, so there's nobody who can take over to pick her up at 4:30, and professionally I don't see how we can meet our financial needs, and at the same time have a rhythm of life where we can bring her in the morning at 8:30 and pick her up at 4:30. I find that impossible. Or at least for me personally, my job doesn't allow it, and in fact it can quickly create well... because it's not that I don't make an effort on this subject, but at some point I can't afford to be at school at 4.30pm, and on the other hand, she can't be at school at 4.30pm every day either. So we can blame each other, well she could blame me for not making the pseudo efforts, but at the same time, my job doesn't allow me to make them. So otherwise I'd have to change jobs. Well, except that I like my job and I don't necessarily want to change. So that can create some, some, some issues... these are issues that we don't necessarily think about in the same way.

Interviewer: Hmm. And so we've talked about conflicts, different evolutions, so I'd like to know what might make you leave your partner.

Participant : Uhhh... on... we're not talking about evolution?

Interviewer: No, just in general, in your relationship, what are things that could make you leave (partner)?

Participant : Uhhh.... Well infidelity, that's one topic. The second subject is disrespect. Uh... the third subject is uh, it's a difference of opinion on a particular subject, I'm just throwing something out there, anything- it's let's say I or she wants to have another child, and has a need or a desire absolutely, and the other person doesn't want to. I think that can be a trigger afterwards.

Interviewer: Right, so that would be a major divergence on a subject on which there can't really be any compromise.

Participant: Right. Yeah.

Interviewer: And in general, would you say that this relationship is good for you, and by good we mean, do you feel that this relationship helps you achieve your goals, do you feel that it helps you regulate yourself a little in your everyday life?

Participant: Not today, no. At one time yes, but not today. Today, I find that the relationship is... in terms of personal balance, I find that it's more of a hindrance than anything else.

Interviewer: Right, a hindrance. Is it for the reasons we talked about earlier or...

Participant: Not necessarily no. Not necessarily. Because there's no subject of a child or anything, at least not on my side. And... and there's no subject of infidelity, at least not that I know of (laughs) and that anyway... if we can find out, but until we know we don't know.

Interviewer: So how does it hinder personal development?

Participant: Because... because... because in fact she has professional wishes, I have a professional routine, and in fact the two are very difficult to assimilate and put together. So I think it's mainly that.

Interviewer: And beyond personal development, would you say that the relationship is good for you in general, or does that aspect really take up a lot of space?

Participant: It's taking up more and more space.

Interviewer: And related to that a little bit, I'd like to know if you think you're the same

person you were before your current relationship, or has this relationship changed you in some way?

Participant: My relationship has changed me, clearly. Yes yes my relationship has changed me but it's not (?). When I say that, I don't see it as something negative.

Interviewer: Okay, and how did it change you then?

Participant : Uh wellll... actually since we've been together for a long time, and at [16-20], I think we didn't do everything at that age, in fact we grew up together and... and I know I wouldn't have had the same life if I hadn't been with her. When I say that, it's because... I wouldn't have made, I wouldn't have taken the professional path I think I've taken if I hadn't been with her, I certainly wouldn't have made the right choices, because when you're with someone, you also think, you think more about the security aspect, the home aspect, than when you're on your own, you think that it's up to you, well if you mess up you mess up, whereas if you're with someone you think that if you mess up it has an impact on uh...on everything else, so in fact, you can't mess up. So I think I've made better choices because I'm with her than if I wasn't with her.

Interviewer: And on her side, do you think she's changed since the beginning of the relationship, or before the relationship?

Participant: Yes, yes yes

Interviewer: And in what way?

Participant: Well, because she... she's actually evolved a lot more than I have on a personal level.

Interviewer: How has it evolved, positively or negatively?

Participant: Well, it's clearly positive for her, because she's developed her convictions over time, she's... after all, she's got a character where she's always had a certain frankness, without being... well, sometimes lacking in distance and tact, but at the same time, you can't take away that frankness from her. And given that she's taken up quite a few convictions on a number of subjects, she's never hesitated to get into a confrontation with someone who didn't have the same opinions as her, for example. So it's something she's also evolved a lot in, because she's grown in convictions on subjects that weren't there before, in fact.

Interviewer: And in general, would you say that you feel secure in this relationship?

Participant: That's a good question. The first answer that comes to me is not to say yes. Because in fact, I don't see why I would be safe. But at the same time, I don't see why I'd be insecure. So it's a bit of a mixed bag.

Interviewer: Yes. For different definitions of safety, here for example, it might be "Do you feel safe? Do you feel you can open up to your partner about your thoughts, about your experiences, without fear of judgment from her or retaliation?"

Participant: Retaliation, no. Judgments, yes. So I would say, for this example, insecure.

Interviewer: Right. And another definition, it could be "Do you feel like you can find comfort and attention from her when you're feeling bad, when you're in distress?"

Participant: No, but because I'm not going to look for it.

Interviewer: Okay.

Participant: It's not that she wouldn't give it, it's that I'm not going to look for it.

Interviewer: And you told me that there can be a certain fear of judgment about certain things. What would that come from?

Participant: Well, differences of opinion. Or actually having a different opinion on a subject. And since she's very strong in her convictions, she can also tend not to listen to other people's arguments and to want to take others with them. So inevitably, it can be a topic.

Interviewer: And now I'd like to talk about another dimension of couple relationships: sexuality. We know that it can be more or less important in a relationship. How important would you say sexuality is in your relationship with (partner)?

Participant: If we scored it on a scale of 0 to 10, I'd say 5.

Interviewer: And 5, would you say that because it's important without being too important, or how would you explain it?

Participant : Actually, it could be important, but it's not. Because I don't think we make the effort to make it so.

Interviewer: Right. And would you like it to become more important or are you satisfied with your sex life right now?

Participant: I wouldn't mind it taking on more importance.

Interviewer: How often do you have sex at the moment?

Participant: It's pretty rare. I'd say it's once a month.

Interviewer: And so, would you like it to be more frequent, for example, when you say

you'd like it to take on more importance?

Participant: Yes.

Interviewer: I've finished with my questions for a while. Now, I'd like to show you some scales, but I don't know if... Do you see me there, on the screen, somewhere?

Participant: Yes, yes, I see you.

Interviewer: And you're not driving?

Participant: No, no, no. I'm still in my car, but I'm not driving.

Interviewer: Perfect. I don't want to show you ladders if you're driving. So I'll share my screen with you.

Participant: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay. So... Okay, it works. Ah, no, it doesn't. Instead of sharing the scales with you, I'll just present them to you. Just give me a moment while I find them again. You can't see my screen, can you?

Participant: No. I still have the camera, yes.

Interviewer: So, on a scale of 1, not true at all, to 9, absolutely true. If I were to ask you, in general, "My partner really listens to me", what would your answer be? So, 1, not at all, and 9, absolutely.

Participant: 4.

Interviewer: 4, right. And why 4?

Participant: Because I think there's a lack of listening.

Interviewer: Okay. Do you have an example of a time when you felt this lack of listening in particular?

Participant: Well, it's actually about something, it's that... Since she absolutely wants to... Because, in fact, she's fully experiencing what she's feeling. She has trouble listening to the other person, in fact, and letting them speak. So, inevitably, if we can't express ourselves properly, it creates this frustration.

Interviewer: So, it's not... Is it the feeling of not being able to share/exchange thoughts, really?

Participant: Yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: So why 4 and not 3, for example, or 5?

Participant: Because there are times when...Why not 3? Because there are times when it's a little different. And why not 5? Because there are more times when it's like that than when it's different.

Interviewer: Okay. And if I asked you, my partner generally listens to my needs, from 1 to 9, what would you say?

Participant: I'd say 5.

Interviewer: 5. Why 5?

Participant: Because it's half and half. There are times when it's really the case, and times when it's not the case at all. So yeah, I'd say it's half and half.

Interviewer: Do you have an example of a moment when you felt this was the case, and a moment when you felt this wasn't so much the case?

Participant: Well, that's...an example... I'm thinking.

Interviewer: Take your time.

Participant: That's a good question. I'm trying to call up memories. I don't see any... I can't think of anything.

Interviewer: That's okay.

Participant: I can't think of anything.

Interviewer: Well, in general, why is it 5 and not 4 or 6?

Participant: Well, because I think it's really half and half. Really, I don't think one side is better than the other. I can't say that the balance is more on one side than the other. I'd say it's really half-and-half.

Interviewer: Right. So you don't feel particularly listened to, or particularly not listened to.

Participant: Yeah. Because it really depends on the moment. In fact, on a subject where she's the one who puts the subject on the table, if she's the one who puts it on the table, it means she has an opinion. And in fact, if she has an opinion, she won't listen to me. On the other hand, if it's a subject I bring up, without her necessarily having thought about it, then she'll listen to me.

Interviewer: Yes, so it depends a little on who cares more about the issue at hand.

Participant: That's it.

Interviewer: Right. And generally speaking, how satisfied are you with your relationship? So it could be completely dissatisfied, very satisfied, rather dissatisfied, neutral, rather satisfied, very satisfied or completely satisfied.

Participant: If I take the state to date, I'd say neutral.

Interviewer: Right. And why neutral then?

Participant: Because in fact, there is a past, there is a past history, there are solid foundations, and so on. We've built things. So that's all positive stuff. But on the other hand, there's routine, there's unheeded needs, whether for one or the other. And that makes things a bit negative all the same.

Interviewer: And now, if I asked you to answer in numerical form, where it would be -10, you are completely dissatisfied and 10, you are completely satisfied, what value would you give to your level of satisfaction in your relationship?

Participant: Between -10 and 10?

Interviewer: Yes.

Participant: I think we're at 0. We're right in the middle.

Interviewer: In the end, it's a good match for neutral.

Participant: Yeah, clearly. It's neutral.

Interviewer: I'm going to ask you why, but maybe it's the same reasons you've already given me.

Participant: Yeah, it's the same reasons.

Interviewer: So, I've finished with all my questions. Now I'd like to send you a questionnaire to fill in. Can I send you a link?

Participant: Of course.

Interviewer: I'll do that. I sent it in the chat. Did you receive it?

Participant: Yes.

Interviewer: This is a questionnaire that will probably take you around 10-15 minutes, I think. If you have any questions, I'll be right here. I'm going to mute myself, but don't hesitate to let me know if there are any questions you don't understand.

Participant: Thank you.

Interviewer: Thank you.